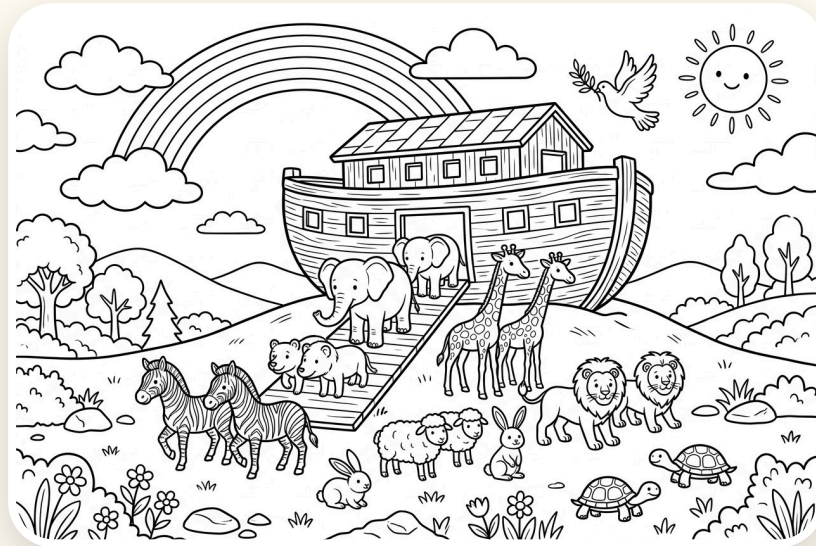


A Thought on Parashat Noach

Dvar Torah - a printable page



Parashat Noach tells about the Flood that swept over the whole world because of people's many sins. It's easy to understand why the people were punished - but why did every other creature in the world have to be swept away too? What did the animals do wrong? After all, animals don't have the understanding to choose between good and bad, so how could they have sinned at all?

We need to know that the whole world was created for mankind, and man is the heart of creation. A person has a huge influence on everything around him - people, animals, plants, and even things that don't move or grow. When a person chooses good, he lifts the whole world up together with him; and when, Heaven forbid, he chooses actions that are not good, he brings the world down with him.

This explains what happened in the time of the Flood. People were so deeply sunk in their sins that they caused the whole world to fall spiritually - so that even the animals went bad. The people themselves brought about the destruction of the world, and caused harm not only to themselves, but to all of creation.

From this we can understand the tremendous power we hold in our hands - to build and repair, or, Heaven forbid, to spoil and destroy. And let's remember that we have the ability to make everything around us a better place.

Shabbat Shalom, and a blessed one!